

Sawyer SRO, LLC
Rental Agreement
Professional Managed by
Full Circle Management

Resident Name: Shaun T McGovern

Address: 2611 N Sawyer Ave., Chicago, IL 60647 All Utilities Included X Yes No

Room Number: 108 Monthly Rent: \$600.00 per month Move-In Fee: \$125.00

Move-In Date: 4/27/2026 Move-Out Date: 4/26/2027 or sooner as agreed upon by all parties.

Short Term or Long Term: Short Term (less than 3 months) X Long Term (12 months)
Initial

I have inspected the room and found it to be in acceptable condition. SM

If long term, I understand and agree to provide three (3) weeks written notice of my move-out or non-renewal date and I will occupy the room for a minimum of 12 weeks. SM

I understand that I must provide my own towels, bed linens and toilet paper. I will not sleep on the mattress or mattress cover directly. Bed lines must be used. SM

I have received a copy of the House Rules and I agree to abide by them. SM

I have received a receipt for payment of all money paid SM

I have received a copy of the EPA publication: Protect your family from Lead SM

I have received a copy of the Chicago Department of Public Health: Preventing Bed Bug Infestations in Apartments. SM

I understand that I must maintain the room in a decent, safe and sanitary condition at all times. SM

Shaun McGovern
Resident Signature

4/28/2026
Date

Management Signature

Date



Sawyer SRO, LLC

House Rules & Regulations

Room Use

The Resident will maintain the room in a decent, safe and sanitary condition at all times in accordance with all health, safety and building code requirements and the City of Chicago Landlord Tenant Ordinance, as applicable.

Rooms are to be occupied by one person only. No pets or flammable liquids are allowed.

Nails, screws or adhesive products are not permitted on any wood surface.

The building has limited storage available and it not guaranteed. Please contact the property manager to determine if storage is available.

Rent

Rent is paid on a weekly basis and in advance. It is due no later than Friday at 5:00 pm for the week beginning Saturday.

A late fee of \$5.00 will be assessed if rent is not paid on time and is limited to a total of \$10.00 per month.

Any personal check that is returned for non-payment will be subject to a non-sufficient funds fee of \$25.00 applied by the owner/agent's financial institution. The rent payment, the fee and any applicable late fees are due immediately upon notice. Failure to pay immediately will be treated as non-payment of rent. If, at any time during the tenancy two (2) checks are not honored for payment, rent payments will be accepted only in the form of cashier's check, bank check or money order or cash.

Rent is not prorated at the termination of tenancy.

Management

The property manager is available Monday – Friday 12:00 pm – 5:00 pm. Saturday by appointment. Management and residents will mutually maintain a businesslike attitude at all times.

The owner/agent and property staff strives to maintain a pleasant, safe and comfortable environment for residents. In consideration of this, all residents and their guests will refrain from any conduct that would conflict with the rights of other residents to the peaceful enjoyment of the premises.

If an applicant/resident or guest demonstrates unprofessional behavior in the presence of the owner/agent and/or property staff or other residents/applicants, the person will be required to leave the management office and/or building.

If the resident, a resident's guest or a resident's family exhibits threatening behavior, appears to be intoxicated or under the influence of alcohol or drugs or attempts to



intimidate the staff, the person(s) will be required to leave the management office and/or building and the situation will be discussed with the resident.

The owner/agent is not responsible for damage or loss of any personal property belonging to the resident.

Grievances & Concerns

The owner/agent and/or property staff works to ensure that this community is a pleasant place for all to live. Excellence in maintenance and management is a top priority. If residents have a concern about this community, the apartment or a suggestion on how needs can be better met, please contact the property staff.

Questions or concerns about the property staff can be reported to the appropriate regional manager or the property management company, Full Circle Management.

Common Areas Personal gas or coal barbecue grills will not be permitted.

Items may not be placed outside of your unit.

Laundry Room Use of the laundry room is restricted to residents. The owner/agent and or property Manager is not liable for any lost or damaged clothing.

Laundry equipment must be used according to its design and instructions. The property staff can assist the resident in understanding how to operate any laundry equipment upon request.

Please contact the property staff as quickly as possible if there are concerns about the laundry room or with any of the laundry equipment.

Laundry must be removed immediately from machines when a cycle is complete. Abandoned laundry will be removed and taken to the management office. Abandoned laundry will be disposed of if it is not claimed within 24 hours.

No dyeing or starching is permitted in the machines.

Residents may not use the laundry room or laundry equipment as part of a home-based business.

Under no circumstances will a resident use the property laundry room to complete tasks required to eradicate bed bugs.



Exterminating /
Bed Bugs

The owner/agent will provide periodic extermination services at no charge to the resident. This is considered part of regular maintenance of the unit. The resident will not attempt to perform extermination tasks. Residents will receive notice before extermination occurs.

Due to an increased concern about bed bugs, if any resident suspects the presence of bed bugs, the resident should attempt to contain the bed bugs in a Ziploc or other sealed bag (property staff will provide a sealable bag upon request) or in a jar that contains ethanol alcohol. This should be kept in the freezer until the property management office opens during normal business hours. The resident should contact the property staff and maintenance will come to the unit to investigate. Do not bring suspected bed bugs to the maintenance office or to the management office.

If the presence of bed bugs is confirmed, the property staff will explain the requirements to eradicate the bed bugs and will work with the resident to schedule eradication.

As long as residents notify the property staff in a timely manner and as long as residents fully and properly participate in all eradication procedures, cost of treatment is the responsibility of the owner/agent. However, cost to replace any items that must be discarded and cost to clean personal items will be the responsibility of the resident.

Failure to notify the owner/agent and failure to fully and properly participate in the eradication process is grounds for immediate termination of tenancy. If the resident fails to notify the owner/agent and/or property staff of an infestation or if the resident fails to fully and properly participate in the eradication process, the resident will be charged for all costs associated with infestation of the unit and other areas. These charges will be considered damage in accordance with HUD notice.

If a licensed exterminator determines that repeated infestations are caused by the resident, resident's guest or service providers hired by the resident, cost of eradication for bed bugs present as a result of the resident's, resident's guests' or resident's service provider's actions will be considered damage and will be charged to the resident. This includes damage to other units and to common areas.

As part of the process to prepare a unit for a new family, the unit will be inspected and will be certified as bed-bug free before a new family moves in. Within five (5) days of move-in, any new resident agrees to participate in a unit inspection. Participation may include use of detection products used to detect bed bugs or other infestations. If the presence of bed bugs is discovered, a professional extermination company will be hired to investigate the source and to begin the eradication process.

Residents agree to fully and properly participate in all eradication procedures including properly preparing the unit based on guidance provided by the owner/agent and/or property staff.



Residents are discouraged from bringing used furniture in to the unit. However, if a resident chooses to bring used furniture in to the unit, the resident must be aware of the risk of bed bug infestation.

Damages

Residents shall not damage or disturb any part of appliances, fixtures, cabinetry, the ceiling, walls, doors or floor in an apartment in anyway, including, but not limited to:

- Installing hooks, nails, and/or other hardware into the ceiling or doors;
- Drilling into the ceiling, cabinets, walls, or doors;
- Hanging light fixtures or other objects from the ceiling without written approval from the owner/agent and/or property staff;
- Allowing water to accumulate on the floor; or
- Painting, repairing, or making improvements with respect to the ceiling, walls, cabinetry, doors or floor.
- Creating an environment or participating in or allowing activity that results in the infestation by bed bugs, fleas or other parasites or rodents

Residents shall immediately report any sagging, warping, leaking, cracking, staining, holes, or water accumulation related to the ceiling, walls, doors or floor to property staff. Any damage the resident causes to the ceiling, walls, doors or floor, including, but not limited to, damages caused by the resident's violation of this rule, shall not constitute ordinary wear and tear.

The resident shall be responsible for reimbursing the owner/agent for the cost of repairing damage to the ceiling, walls, doors or floor and for any damages that result as a consequence of the resident's action.

At unit inspection and at move-out, residents may be charged for damages that exceed normal wear and tear to the unit. These charges are due within thirty (30) days.

If the damage charges are assessed at move-out, the resident will be responsible for paying for such damages within thirty (30) days.

Hazardous/ Infectious Waste Disposal

Hazardous waste, gasoline and any combustible items are not to be stored or disposed of within the unit or building. All hazardous waste must be disposed of in accordance with city code.

Infectious waste from the use of medical supplies must be handled properly.

Needles and sharps must be packaged in a fashion that would minimize opportunity for contact injury. Needles and syringes must be discarded properly after use. Needles



should never be bent, broken or manipulated. These items must be placed in a medical grade sharps container.

Maintenance It is the responsibility of each resident to promptly report any maintenance problem. Charges for damages resulting from unreported maintenance problems will be assessed.

Routine maintenance requests are made by contacting the property staff during normal business hours. Emergency maintenance service is available twenty-four (24) hours a day via the property's management office.

Should the resident not be home during the time of the repair, maintenance will leave notice stating, maintenance entered the unit, completed repair and or leave information regarding the repair and the name of the maintenance person entering the unit.

After hours number(s) are provided by the owner/agent and/or property staff. Examples of maintenance emergencies include but are not limited to:

Flooding
No heat (in the winter)
No electricity
Water coming into the unit
No running water
Exterior door, window or lock broken and unable to secure unit
Inoperable toilet
Inoperable refrigerator

Should a maintenance emergency occur during regular office hours, contact the property staff at the management office via email or phone or report the emergency in person.

In the event of a health, fire, or safety emergency, call 911 or your local emergency response agency immediately.

The owner/agent's staff is not permitted to perform repairs on any resident's personal property or to perform any type of personal work for residents.

Plumbing - Trying to flush or pour certain items is known to cause problems with plumbing. These items include but are not limited to grease, large food items, personal hygiene items, toys and diapers. The resident will not attempt to flush or pour these items through the drainage system.

Residents are allowed to attempt to plunge clogged drains, however use of "DRAIN-O" and similar caustic substances should be avoided as they can damage pipes and/or cause personal injury. The owner/agent and/or property staff is not liable for injury caused by use of such products.



The resident must contact maintenance if a sink or toilet is overflowing.

Residents may not dispose of paint or other chemicals using property sinks, toilets or drains.

Overflowing toilets, baths or sinks constitute a “maintenance emergency” and the resident agrees to contact the property staff as quickly as possible even if the event occurs after normal office hours.

The resident will be billed for repair of damages caused by improper use of toilets or sinks. These charges must be paid within thirty (30) days.

Garbage

The owner/agent and/or property staff will not allow any accumulated trash or other material that will create a hazard or that will be in violation of any health, fire or safety ordinance. No trash or garbage accumulation is allowed in the unit. No discarded trash, garbage, and/or household or personal item(s) is allowed in storage areas, laundry facilities, common areas, or anywhere on the property and must be placed in dumpsters provided by the building.

Dumpsters are provided for the purpose of trash and garbage disposal. Dumpsters are reserved for personal use by residents only.

Residents are required to use the appropriate containers provided. Resident shall sort and separate such items into categories as provided by law.

All trash and garbage must be placed in a plastic bag, tied/sealed, and properly placed **inside** the dumpster. Trash and garbage are not to be placed on top or beside the dumpster(s). Residents are responsible for the proper disposal of trash/garbage.

Each resident agrees, at his/her sole cost and expense, to comply with all present and future laws, orders, and regulations of all state, federal, municipal, and local governments, departments, commissions, and boards regarding the collection, sorting, separation, and recycling of waste products, garbage, refuse, and trash.

It is the responsibility of the resident to remove from the property, and properly dispose of, all unwanted household items or personal property. The placing of discarded furniture or other personal property in or around the dumpster(s), and/or any common areas, or within the property boundaries is strictly prohibited. Residents may contact the property staff for information about removing such items. Cost of such removal is the responsibility of the resident.

The owner/agent and/or property staff reserves the right, where permitted by law, to refuse to collect or accept from the resident any waste products, garbage, refuse, or trash which is not allowed to be placed in the dumpsters by the dumpster contractor and to



require resident to arrange for such collection, at the resident's sole cost and expense, using a contractor satisfactory to the owner/agent and/or property staff.

The dumpster lids or doors must be kept closed at all times to discourage unwanted entry by birds, animals or people.

The placing or dumping of any highly flammable material in the waste container(s), which will or may cause a fire in the dumpster, is strictly prohibited.

Grease, paint, acids, and other problem materials may not be disposed of in the dumpster

Health &

Safety

The health and safety of all residents, guests and staff is of the utmost importance.

Please notify the property manager of any conditions that you believe to be unsafe.

No additional locking device may be attached to any door or window.

You hereby agree that in the event of a health or safety related situation sensed by management by either sight, sound or smell, and you do not acknowledge a knock at the door, management will enter the unit to assess and correct the issue.

Guests

Guests are permitted on a limited basis. An excessive number of guests or noise disturbances will not be permitted.

Management reserves the right to refuse entry to any guest or request the guest to leave the premises.

If you are expecting guests, you must meet them in the front of the building. Yelling or car honking is not permitted.

Bathrooms

The cleanliness of the bathrooms is the responsibility of each resident. You agree to clean the bathroom from your usage before leaving the bathroom.

Foreign objects are not permitted to be disposed in the toilets, including but not limited to feminine products, condoms, paper towels, napkins, etc.

When showering, please make sure the shower door is fully closed.

Energy

The building attempts to employ good energy efficiency practices and you agree to cooperate in our efforts.

Please make sure to turn off all lights, radios, televisions, fans etc. before leaving the unit.



You agree that in the event management senses any of the above listed and you do not acknowledge management at the door, management will enter the unit to assess and correct the issue.

Telephone The property manager’s phone is for business use only. A message will be taken by the property manager in the event of an emergency, not as a convenience.
All units are equipped with telephone jacks and service may be established by the resident.

Fair Housing The Fair Housing Act prohibits discrimination in housing and housing related transactions based on race, color, religion, sex, national origin, disability, and familial status. In addition, the state of Illinois has added Fair Housing protections based on ancestry, age, marital status, order of protection status, sexual orientation, Gender and unfavorable discharge from military service.

Resident Certification

I have read and received a copy of the House Rules. I understand that these rules are condition of my tenancy and that any violation of these rules may be grounds for termination of tenancy.

Shaun McGovern
Resident Signature

4/28/2026
Date

Management Representative for Sawyer SRO, LLC

Date



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LEASE ADDENDUM

VIOLENCE AGAINST WOMEN AND JUSTICE DEPARTMENT REAUTHORIZATION ACT OF 2005

TENANT	LANDLORD	UNIT NO. & ADDRESS
Shaun T McGovern	SAWYER SRO, LLC	2611 N SAWYER AVE #108 CHICAGO, IL 60647

This lease addendum adds the following paragraphs to the Lease between the above referenced Tenant and Landlord.

Purpose of the Addendum

The lease for the above referenced unit is being amended to include the provisions of the Violence Against Women and Justice Department Reauthorization Act of 2005 (VAWA).

Conflicts with Other Provisions of the Lease

In case of any conflict between the provisions of this Addendum and other sections of the Lease, the provisions of this Addendum shall prevail.

Term of the Lease Addendum

The effective date of this Lease Addendum is 4/1/2026. This Lease Addendum shall continue to be in effect until the Lease is terminated.

VAWA Protections

1. The Landlord may not consider incidents of domestic violence, dating violence or stalking as serious or repeated violations of the lease or other "good cause" for termination of assistance, tenancy or occupancy rights of the victim of abuse.
2. The Landlord may not consider criminal activity directly relating to abuse, engaged in by a member of a tenant's household or any guest or other person under the tenant's control, cause for termination of assistance, tenancy, or occupancy rights if the tenant or an immediate member of the tenant's family is the victim or threatened victim of that abuse.
3. The Landlord may request in writing that the victim, or a family member on the victim's behalf, certify that the individual is a victim of abuse and that the Certification of Domestic Violence, Dating Violence or Stalking, Form HUD-91066, or other documentation as noted on the certification form, be completed and submitted within 14 business days, or an agreed upon extension date, to receive protection under the VAWA. Failure to provide the certification or other supporting documentation within the specified timeframe may result in eviction.

Shaun McGovern
Tenant

4/28/2026
Date

Landlord

Date



Protect Your Family From Lead in Your Home



Are You Planning to Buy or Rent a Home Built Before 1978?

Did you know that many homes built before 1978 have **lead-based paint**? Lead from paint, chips, and dust can pose serious health hazards.

Read this entire brochure to learn:

- How lead gets into the body
- How lead affects health
- What you can do to protect your family
- Where to go for more information

Before renting or buying a pre-1978 home or apartment, federal law requires:

- Sellers must disclose known information on lead-based paint or lead-based paint hazards before selling a house.
- Real estate sales contracts must include a specific warning statement about lead-based paint. Buyers have up to 10 days to check for lead.
- Landlords must disclose known information on lead-based paint or lead-based paint hazards before leases take effect. Leases must include a specific warning statement about lead-based paint.

If undertaking renovations, repairs, or painting (RRP) projects in your pre-1978 home or apartment:

- Read EPA's pamphlet, *The Lead-Safe Certified Guide to Renovate Right*, to learn about the lead-safe work practices that contractors are required to follow when working in your home (see page 12).



March 2021

Simple Steps to Protect Your Family from Lead Hazards

If you think your home has lead-based paint:

- Don't try to remove lead-based paint yourself.
- Always keep painted surfaces in good condition to minimize deterioration.
- Get your home checked for lead hazards. Find a certified inspector or risk assessor at epa.gov/lead.
- Talk to your landlord about fixing surfaces with peeling or chipping paint.
- Regularly clean floors, window sills, and other surfaces.
- Take precautions to avoid exposure to lead dust when remodeling.
- When renovating, repairing, or painting, hire only EPA- or state-approved Lead-Safe certified renovation firms.
- Before buying, renting, or renovating your home, have it checked for lead-based paint.
- Consult your health care provider about testing your children for lead. Your pediatrician can check for lead with a simple blood test.
- Wash children's hands, bottles, pacifiers, and toys often.
- Make sure children eat healthy, low-fat foods high in iron, calcium, and vitamin C.
- Remove shoes or wipe soil off shoes before entering your house.

Lead Gets into the Body in Many Ways

Adults and children can get lead into their bodies if they:

- Breathe in lead dust (especially during activities such as renovations, repairs, or painting that disturb painted surfaces).
- Swallow lead dust that has settled on food, food preparation surfaces, and other places.
- Eat paint chips or soil that contains lead.

Lead is especially dangerous to children under the age of 6.

- At this age, children's brains and nervous systems are more sensitive to the damaging effects of lead.
- Children's growing bodies absorb more lead.
- Babies and young children often put their hands and other objects in their mouths. These objects can have lead dust on them.



Women of childbearing age should know that lead is dangerous to a developing fetus.

- Women with a high lead level in their system before or during pregnancy risk exposing the fetus to lead through the placenta during fetal development.

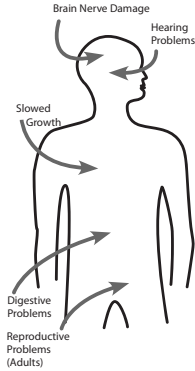
Health Effects of Lead

Lead affects the body in many ways. It is important to know that even exposure to low levels of lead can severely harm children.

In children, exposure to lead can cause:

- Nervous system and kidney damage
- Learning disabilities, attention-deficit disorder, and decreased intelligence
- Speech, language, and behavior problems
- Poor muscle coordination
- Decreased muscle and bone growth
- Hearing damage

While low-lead exposure is most common, exposure to high amounts of lead can have devastating effects on children, including seizures, unconsciousness, and in some cases, death.



Although children are especially susceptible to lead exposure, lead can be dangerous for adults, too.

In adults, exposure to lead can cause:

- Harm to a developing fetus
- Increased chance of high blood pressure during pregnancy
- Fertility problems (in men and women)
- High blood pressure
- Digestive problems
- Nerve disorders
- Memory and concentration problems
- Muscle and joint pain

Check Your Family for Lead

Get your children and home tested if you think your home has lead.

Children’s blood lead levels tend to increase rapidly from 6 to 12 months of age, and tend to peak at 18 to 24 months of age.

Consult your doctor for advice on testing your children. A simple blood test can detect lead. Blood lead tests are usually recommended for:

- Children at ages 1 and 2
- Children or other family members who have been exposed to high levels of lead
- Children who should be tested under your state or local health screening plan

Your doctor can explain what the test results mean and if more testing will be needed.

Where Lead-Based Paint Is Found

In general, the older your home or childcare facility, the more likely it has lead-based paint.¹

Many homes, including private, federally-assisted, federally-owned housing, and childcare facilities built before 1978 have lead-based paint. In 1978, the federal government banned consumer uses of lead-containing paint.²

Learn how to determine if paint is lead-based paint on page 7.

Lead can be found:

- In homes and childcare facilities in the city, country, or suburbs,
- In private and public single-family homes and apartments,
- On surfaces inside and outside of the house, and
- In soil around a home. (Soil can pick up lead from exterior paint or other sources, such as past use of leaded gas in cars.)

Learn more about where lead is found at epa.gov/lead.

¹ “Lead-based paint” is currently defined by the federal government as paint with lead levels greater than or equal to 1.0 milligram per square centimeter (mg/cm²), or more than 0.5% by weight.

² “Lead-containing paint” is currently defined by the federal government as lead in new dried paint in excess of 90 parts per million (ppm) by weight.

Identifying Lead-Based Paint and Lead-Based Paint Hazards

Deteriorated lead-based paint (peeling, chipping, chalking, cracking, or damaged paint) is a hazard and needs immediate attention. Lead-based paint may also be a hazard when found on surfaces that children can chew or that get a lot of wear and tear, such as:

- On windows and window sills
- Doors and door frames
- Stairs, railings, banisters, and porches

Lead-based paint is usually not a hazard if it is in good condition and if it is not on an impact or friction surface like a window.

Lead dust can form when lead-based paint is scraped, sanded, or heated. Lead dust also forms when painted surfaces containing lead bump or rub together. Lead paint chips and dust can get on surfaces and objects that people touch. Settled lead dust can reenter the air when the home is vacuumed or swept, or when people walk through it. EPA currently defines the following levels of lead in dust as hazardous:

- 10 micrograms per square foot (µg/ft²) and higher for floors, including carpeted floors
- 100 µg/ft² and higher for interior window sills

Lead in soil can be a hazard when children play in bare soil or when people bring soil into the house on their shoes. EPA currently defines the following levels of lead in soil as hazardous:

- 400 parts per million (ppm) and higher in play areas of bare soil
- 1,200 ppm (average) and higher in bare soil in the remainder of the yard

Remember, lead from paint chips—which you can see—and lead dust—which you may not be able to see—both can be hazards.

The only way to find out if paint, dust, or soil lead hazards exist is to test for them. The next page describes how to do this.

Checking Your Home for Lead

You can get your home tested for lead in several different ways:

- A lead-based paint **inspection** tells you if your home has lead-based paint and where it is located. It won't tell you whether your home currently has lead hazards. A trained and certified testing professional, called a lead-based paint inspector, will conduct a paint inspection using methods, such as:
 - Portable x-ray fluorescence (XRF) machine
 - Lab tests of paint samples
- A **risk assessment** tells you if your home currently has any lead hazards from lead in paint, dust, or soil. It also tells you what actions to take to address any hazards. A trained and certified testing professional, called a risk assessor, will:
 - Sample paint that is deteriorated on doors, windows, floors, stairs, and walls
 - Sample dust near painted surfaces and sample bare soil in the yard
 - Get lab tests of paint, dust, and soil samples
- A combination inspection and risk assessment tells you if your home has any lead-based paint and if your home has any lead hazards, and where both are located.



Be sure to read the report provided to you after your inspection or risk assessment is completed, and ask questions about anything you do not understand.

Checking Your Home for Lead, continued

In preparing for renovation, repair, or painting work in a pre-1978 home, Lead-Safe Certified renovators (see page 12) may:

- Take paint chip samples to determine if lead-based paint is present in the area planned for renovation and send them to an EPA-recognized lead lab for analysis. In housing receiving federal assistance, the person collecting these samples must be a certified lead-based paint inspector or risk assessor
- Use EPA-recognized tests kits to determine if lead-based paint is absent (but not in housing receiving federal assistance)
- Presume that lead-based paint is present and use lead-safe work practices

There are state and federal programs in place to ensure that testing is done safely, reliably, and effectively. Contact your state or local agency for more information, visit epa.gov/lead, or call **1-800-424-LEAD (5323)** for a list of contacts in your area.³

³ Hearing- or speech-challenged individuals may access this number through TTY by calling the Federal Relay Service at 1-800-877-8339.

What You Can Do Now to Protect Your Family

If you suspect that your house has lead-based paint hazards, you can take some immediate steps to reduce your family's risk:

- If you rent, notify your landlord of peeling or chipping paint.
- Keep painted surfaces clean and free of dust. Clean floors, window frames, window sills, and other surfaces weekly. Use a mop or sponge with warm water and a general all-purpose cleaner. (Remember: never mix ammonia and bleach products together because they can form a dangerous gas.)
- Carefully clean up paint chips immediately without creating dust.
- Thoroughly rinse sponges and mop heads often during cleaning of dirty or dusty areas, and again afterward.
- Wash your hands and your children's hands often, especially before they eat and before nap time and bed time.
- Keep play areas clean. Wash bottles, pacifiers, toys, and stuffed animals regularly.
- Keep children from chewing window sills or other painted surfaces, or eating soil.
- When renovating, repairing, or painting, hire only EPA- or state-approved Lead-Safe Certified renovation firms (see page 12).
- Clean or remove shoes before entering your home to avoid tracking in lead from soil.
- Make sure children eat nutritious, low-fat meals high in iron, and calcium, such as spinach and dairy products. Children with good diets absorb less lead.

Reducing Lead Hazards

Disturbing lead-based paint or removing lead improperly can increase the hazard to your family by spreading even more lead dust around the house.

- In addition to day-to-day cleaning and good nutrition, you can **temporarily** reduce lead-based paint hazards by taking actions, such as repairing damaged painted surfaces and planting grass to cover lead-contaminated soil. These actions are not permanent solutions and will need ongoing attention.
- You can minimize exposure to lead when renovating, repairing, or painting by hiring an EPA- or state-certified renovator who is trained in the use of lead-safe work practices. If you are a do-it-yourselfer, learn how to use lead-safe work practices in your home.
- To remove lead hazards permanently, you should hire a certified lead abatement contractor. Abatement (or permanent hazard elimination) methods include removing, sealing, or enclosing lead-based paint with special materials. Just painting over the hazard with regular paint is not permanent control.



Always use a certified contractor who is trained to address lead hazards safely.

- Hire a Lead-Safe Certified firm (see page 12) to perform renovation, repair, or painting (RRP) projects that disturb painted surfaces.
- To correct lead hazards permanently, hire a certified lead abatement contractor. This will ensure your contractor knows how to work safely and has the proper equipment to clean up thoroughly.

Certified contractors will employ qualified workers and follow strict safety rules as set by their state or by the federal government.

Reducing Lead Hazards, continued

If your home has had lead abatement work done or if the housing is receiving federal assistance, once the work is completed, dust cleanup activities must be conducted until clearance testing indicates that lead dust levels are below the following levels:

- 10 micrograms per square foot (µg/ft²) for floors, including carpeted floors
- 100 µg/ft² for interior windows sills
- 400 µg/ft² for window troughs

Abatementers are designed to permanently eliminate lead-based paint hazards. However, lead dust can be reintroduced into an abated area.

- Use a HEPA vacuum on all furniture and other items returned to the area, to reduce the potential for reintroducing lead dust.
- Regularly clean floors, window sills, troughs, and other hard surfaces with a damp cloth or sponge and a general all-purpose cleaner.

Please see page 9 for more information on steps you can take to protect your home after the abatement. For help in locating certified lead abatement professionals in your area, call your state or local agency (see pages 15 and 16), epa.gov/lead, or call 1-800-424-LEAD.

Renovating, Repairing or Painting a Home with Lead-Based Paint

If you hire a contractor to conduct renovation, repair, or painting (RRP) projects in your pre-1978 home or childcare facility (such as pre-school and kindergarten), your contractor must:

- Be a Lead-Safe Certified firm approved by EPA or an EPA-authorized state program
- Use qualified trained individuals (Lead-Safe Certified renovators) who follow specific lead-safe work practices to prevent lead contamination
- Provide a copy of EPA's lead hazard information document, *The Lead-Safe Certified Guide to Renovate Right*



RRP contractors working in pre-1978 homes and childcare facilities must follow lead-safe work practices that:

- **Contain the work area.** The area must be contained so that dust and debris do not escape from the work area. Warning signs must be put up, and plastic or other impermeable material and tape must be used.
- **Avoid renovation methods that generate large amounts of lead-contaminated dust.** Some methods generate so much lead-contaminated dust that their use is prohibited. They are:
 - Open-flame burning or torching
 - Sanding, grinding, planing, needle gunning, or blasting with power tools and equipment not equipped with a shroud and HEPA vacuum attachment
 - Using a heat gun at temperatures greater than 1100°F
- **Clean up thoroughly.** The work area should be cleaned up daily. When all the work is done, the area must be cleaned up using special cleaning methods.
- **Dispose of waste properly.** Collect and seal waste in a heavy duty bag or sheeting. When transported, ensure that waste is contained to prevent release of dust and debris.

To learn more about EPA's requirements for RRP projects, visit epa.gov/getleadsafe, or read *The Lead-Safe Certified Guide to Renovate Right*.

Other Sources of Lead

Lead in Drinking Water

The most common sources of lead in drinking water are lead pipes, faucets, and fixtures.

Lead pipes are more likely to be found in older cities and homes built before 1986.

You can't smell or taste lead in drinking water.

To find out for certain if you have lead in drinking water, have your water tested.

Remember older homes with a private well can also have plumbing materials that contain lead.

Important Steps You Can Take to Reduce Lead in Drinking Water

- Use only cold water for drinking, cooking and making baby formula. Remember, boiling water does not remove lead from water.
- Before drinking, flush your home's pipes by running the tap, taking a shower, doing laundry, or doing a load of dishes.
- Regularly clean your faucet's screen (also known as an aerator).
- If you use a filter certified to remove lead, don't forget to read the directions to learn when to change the cartridge. Using a filter after it has expired can make it less effective at removing lead.

Contact your water company to determine if the pipe that connects your home to the water main (called a service line) is made from lead. Your area's water company can also provide information about the lead levels in your system's drinking water.

For more information about lead in drinking water, please contact EPA's Safe Drinking Water Hotline at 1-800-426-4791. If you have other questions about lead poisoning prevention, call 1-800 424-LEAD.*

Call your local health department or water company to find out about testing your water, or visit epa.gov/safewater for EPA's lead in drinking water information. Some states or utilities offer programs to pay for water testing for residents. Contact your state or local water company to learn more.

13 * Hearing- or speech-challenged individuals may access this number through TTY by calling the Federal Relay Service at 1-800-877-8339.

Other Sources of Lead, continued

- **Lead smelters** or other industries that release lead into the air.
- **Your job.** If you work with lead, you could bring it home on your body or clothes. Shower and change clothes before coming home. Launder your work clothes separately from the rest of your family's clothes.
- **Hobbies** that use lead, such as making pottery or stained glass, or refinishing furniture. Call your local health department for information about hobbies that may use lead.
- Old **toys** and **furniture** may have been painted with lead-containing paint. Older toys and other children's products may have parts that contain lead.⁴
- Food and liquids cooked or stored in **lead crystal** or **lead-glazed pottery or porcelain** may contain lead.
- Folk remedies, such as **"greta"** and **"azarcon,"** used to treat an upset stomach.

⁴ In 1978, the federal government banned toys, other children's products, and furniture with lead-containing paint. In 2008, the federal government banned lead in most children's products. The federal government currently bans lead in excess of 100 ppm by weight in most children's products.

For More Information

The National Lead Information Center

Learn how to protect children from lead poisoning and get other information about lead hazards on the Web at epa.gov/lead and hud.gov/lead, or call **1-800-424-LEAD (5323)**.

EPA's Safe Drinking Water Hotline

For information about lead in drinking water, call **1-800-426-4791**, or visit epa.gov/safewater for information about lead in drinking water.

Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) Hotline

For information on lead in toys and other consumer products, or to report an unsafe consumer product or a product-related injury, call **1-800-638-2772**, or visit CPSC's website at cpsc.gov or saferproducts.gov.

State and Local Health and Environmental Agencies

Some states, tribes, and cities have their own rules related to lead-based paint. Check with your local agency to see which laws apply to you. Most agencies can also provide information on finding a lead abatement firm in your area, and on possible sources of financial aid for reducing lead hazards. Receive up-to-date address and phone information for your state or local contacts on the Web at epa.gov/lead, or contact the National Lead Information Center at **1-800-424-LEAD**.

Hearing- or speech-challenged individuals may access any of the phone numbers in this brochure through TTY by calling the toll-free Federal Relay Service at **1-800-877-8339**.

U. S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)
Regional Offices

The mission of EPA is to protect human health and the environment. Your Regional EPA Office can provide further information regarding regulations and lead protection programs.

Region 1 (Connecticut, Massachusetts, Maine, New Hampshire, Rhode Island, Vermont)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 1
5 Post Office Square, Suite 100, OES 05-4
Boston, MA 02109-3912
(888) 372-7341

Region 2 (New Jersey, New York, Puerto Rico, Virgin Islands)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 2
2890 Woodbridge Avenue
Building 205, Mail Stop 225
Edison, NJ 08837-3679
(732) 906-6809

Region 3 (Delaware, Maryland, Pennsylvania, Virginia, DC, West Virginia)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 3
1650 Arch Street
Philadelphia, PA 19103
(215) 814-2088

Region 4 (Alabama, Florida, Georgia, Kentucky, Mississippi, North Carolina, South Carolina, Tennessee)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 4
AFC Tower, 12th Floor, Air, Pesticides & Toxics
61 Forsyth Street, SW
Atlanta, GA 30303
(404) 562-8998

Region 5 (Illinois, Indiana, Michigan, Minnesota, Ohio, Wisconsin)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 5 (LL-17J)
77 West Jackson Boulevard
Chicago, IL 60604-3666
(312) 353-3808

Region 6 (Arkansas, Louisiana, New Mexico, Oklahoma, Texas, and 66 Tribes)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 6
1445 Ross Avenue, 12th Floor
Dallas, TX 75202-2733
(214) 665-2704

Region 7 (Iowa, Kansas, Missouri, Nebraska)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 7
11201 Renner Blvd.
Lenexa, KS 66219
(800) 223-0425

Region 8 (Colorado, Montana, North Dakota, South Dakota, Utah, Wyoming)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 8
1595 Wynkoop St.
Denver, CO 80202
(303) 312-6966

Region 9 (Arizona, California, Hawaii, Nevada)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 9 (CMD-4-2)
75 Hawthorne Street
San Francisco, CA 94105
(415) 947-4280

Region 10 (Alaska, Idaho, Oregon, Washington)

Regional Lead Contact
U.S. EPA Region 10 (20-C04)
Air and Toxics Enforcement Section
1200 Sixth Avenue, Suite 155
Seattle, WA 98101
(206) 553-1200

Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC)

The CPSC protects the public against unreasonable risk of injury from consumer products through education, safety standards activities, and enforcement. Contact CPSC for further information regarding consumer product safety and regulations.

CPSC

4330 East West Highway
Bethesda, MD 20814-4421
1-800-638-2772
cpsc.gov or saferproducts.gov

U. S. Department of Housing and Urban Development (HUD)

HUD's mission is to create strong, sustainable, inclusive communities and quality affordable homes for all. Contact to Office of Lead Hazard Control and Healthy Homes for further information regarding the Lead Safe Housing Rule, which protects families in pre-1978 assisted housing, and for the lead hazard control and research grant programs.

HUD

451 Seventh Street, SW, Room 8236
Washington, DC 20410-3000
(202) 402-7698
hud.gov/lead

This document is in the public domain. It may be produced by an individual or organization without permission. Information provided in this booklet is based upon current scientific and technical understanding of the issues presented and is reflective of the jurisdictional boundaries established by the statutes governing the co-authoring agencies. Following the advice given will not necessarily provide complete protection in all situations or against all health hazards that can be caused by lead exposure.

IMPORTANT!

Lead From Paint, Dust, and Soil in and Around Your Home Can Be Dangerous if Not Managed Properly

- Children under 6 years old are most at risk for lead poisoning in your home.
- Lead exposure can harm young children and babies even before they are born.
- Homes, schools, and child care facilities built before 1978 are likely to contain lead-based paint.
- Even children who seem healthy may have dangerous levels of lead in their bodies.
- Disturbing surfaces with lead-based paint or removing lead-based paint improperly can increase the danger to your family.
- People can get lead into their bodies by breathing or swallowing lead dust, or by eating soil or paint chips containing lead.
- People have many options for reducing lead hazards. Generally, lead-based paint that is in good condition is not a hazard (see page 10).

Disclosure of Information on Lead-Based Paint and/or Lead-Based Paint Hazards

Lead Warning Statement

Housing built before 1978 may contain lead-based paint. Lead from paint, paint chips, and dust can pose health hazards if not managed properly. Lead exposure is especially harmful to young children and pregnant women. Before renting pre-1978 housing, lessors must disclose the presence of known lead-based paint and/or lead-based paint hazards in the dwelling. Lessees must also receive a federally approved pamphlet on lead poisoning prevention.

Lessor's Disclosure

(a) Presence of lead-based paint and/or lead-based paint hazards (check (i) or (ii) below):

(i) _____ Known lead-based paint and/or lead-based paint hazards are present in the housing (explain).

(ii) _____ Lessor has no knowledge of lead-based paint and/or lead-based paint hazards in the housing.

(b) Records and reports available to the lessor (check (i) or (ii) below):

(i) _____ Lessor has provided the lessee with all available records and reports pertaining to lead-based paint and/or lead-based paint hazards in the housing (list documents below).

(ii) _____ Lessor has no reports or records pertaining to lead-based paint and/or lead-based paint hazards in the housing.

Lessee's Acknowledgment (initial)

(c) SM Lessee has received copies of all information listed above.

(d) SM Lessee has received the pamphlet *Protect Your Family from Lead in Your Home*.

Agent's Acknowledgment (initial)

(e) _____ Agent has informed the lessor of the lessor's obligations under 42 U.S.C. 4852d and is aware of his/her responsibility to ensure compliance.

Certification of Accuracy

The following parties have reviewed the information above and certify, to the best of their knowledge, that the information they have provided is true and accurate.

Lessor	Date	Lessor	Date
<u>Shaun McGovern</u>	4/28/2026		
Lessee	Date	Lessee	Date
Agent	Date	Agent	Date



Chicago Rents Right

Good Tenants, Good Landlords, Great Neighborhoods!



Brandon Johnson
Mayor of Chicago

Approved by the City of Chicago: July 2020
Summary Revised: December 2023



Residential Landlord Tenant Ordinance Summary

At initial offering, this Summary of the ordinance must be attached to every written rental agreement and upon initial offering for renewal. The Summary must also be given to a tenant at initial offering of an oral agreement, whether the agreement is new or a renewal.

{Mun. Code Ch. 5-12-170}

IMPORTANT: IF YOU SEEK TO EXERCISE RIGHTS UNDER THE ORDINANCE, OBTAIN A COPY OF THE ENTIRE ORDINANCE TO DETERMINE APPROPRIATE REMEDIES AND PROCEDURES. CONSULTING AN ATTORNEY IS RECOMMENDED.

Any terms in a lease that conflicts with applicable portions of the RLTO are unenforceable.

IMPORTANT NOTICE—These provisions apply to *all* residential units, regardless of whether they are covered by the RLTO.

Under the 2020 revisions of the RLTO (“Fair Notice Ordinance”), Landlords must provide a tenant that is not in the eviction process:

- 30 days of notice to terminate a month-to-month tenancy, decline to renew your lease or raise your rent if you have lived in your apartment for less than six months.
- 60 days of notice for the same if you have lived in your apartment for more than six months but less than three years.
- 120 days of notice for the same if you have lived in your apartment for more than three years.

Lockouts are illegal under Ordinance

- It is illegal for a landlord to lock out a tenant. Examples include: changing, removing, or plugging locks; removing doors or windows of a rental unit; removing tenant’s personal property from a rental unit; cutting off heat, utility or water services; or doing anything else which that makes any part of the unit or tenant’s personal property inaccessible or uninhabitable for the purpose of forcing the tenant to move
 - The Police Department is responsible for enforcement of the RLTO’s prohibition against lockouts. (Police Special Order 93-12)
 - The landlord shall be fined \$200-\$500 for each day the lockout occurs or continues.
-

What rental units are not covered by the Ordinance? {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-010 & 5-12-020}

- Units in owner occupied buildings with six or fewer units.
- Units in hotels, motels, rooming houses, unless rent is paid monthly and the unit is occupied for more than 32 continuous days.
- School dormitory rooms, hospitals, shelters, employee’s quarters, non-residential rental properties.
- Owner occupied co-ops and condominiums.
- Employee housing

IMPORTANT NOTICE- The following provisions apply only to rental units covered by the RLTO

Under the Fair Notice Ordinance, if you have been given an eviction notice for nonpayment

You now have the one-time right to remain in your apartment and end the eviction case against you if you: pay all your back rent owed and pay any court filing fees your landlord has paid in your eviction case. You are free to make these payments until a judge issues a formal eviction order against you.

What are tenants required to do?*



The tenant, the tenant's family, and invited guests must comply with all obligations imposed specifically upon tenants by provision of the Municipal Code, applicable to dwelling units, including section 7-28-850 {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-040; 14X-1-103.3}:

- Buying and installing working batteries in smoke and carbon monoxide detectors within tenant's apartment.
- Regularly testing smoke alarms and carbon monoxide alarms and notifying the owner in writing of any deficiencies.
- Keeping the unit safe and clean.

The tenant must permit access to the rental unit to the landlord upon receiving two days' notice that the landlord intends to enter for the following purposes {Mun. Code Ch. 5-12-050}:

- Make repairs, supply services and perform necessary inspections

In cases of emergency, the tenant must allow access to the rental unit without receiving two days' notice.

***For a complete list, review the [RLTO Ordinance](#).**

Please note: Except in cases of emergencies, tenants should not change the locks on their units without first notifying their landlord. If the tenant does change the locks, they must provide the landlord with a key.

What are landlords required to do?*

- Give tenant written notice of the owner's or manager's name, address, and telephone number or for a person authorized to act on behalf of the owner for the purpose of service of process and for the purpose of receiving notices and demands. {Mun. Code Ch. 5-12-090}
- Within seven days of being served a foreclosure complaint, an owner or landlord of a premises that is the subject of the foreclosure complaint shall disclose, in writing, to all tenants of the premises that a foreclosure action has been filed. The owner or landlord shall also notify of a foreclosure suit, in writing, before a tenant signs a lease. {Mun. Code Ch. 5-12-095}
- To give new or renewing tenants notice of:
 1. Code citations issued by the City in the previous 12 months for the rental unit or common areas;
 2. Pending Housing Court or administrative hearing actions affecting the rental unit or common areas;
 3. During the entire occupancy, any notice of intent by a utility provider to shut off Water, electrical or gas service to the building. {Mun. Code Ch. 5-12-100}
- To maintain the property in compliance with all applicable provisions of the Municipal Code. {Mun. Code Ch. 5-12-070}

***For a complete list, review the [RLTO Ordinance](#).**

SECURITY DEPOSITS AND PREPAID RENT {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-080 AND 5-12-081}*

- A landlord must give a tenant a receipt for a security deposit; however, if the security deposit is paid electronically, the landlord has the option to give an electronic receipt.
- A landlord must hold all security deposits in a federally insured interest-bearing account in a financial institution located in Illinois. Security deposits and interest thereon shall not be commingled with the assets of the landlord.
- The landlord must provide via a written rental agreement or in other writing within 14 days of receipt of the security deposit detailing which financial institution the security deposit will be deposited.
- A landlord must pay interest each year on security deposits and prepaid rent held more than six months by either cash or credit to be applied to rent due. The rate of interest a landlord must pay is set each year by the City Comptroller.
- Before expenses for damages can be deducted from the security deposit, the landlord must provide the tenant with an itemized statement of the damages within 30 days of the date the tenant vacates and an estimated or actual cost for repairing or replacing damaged items, attaching copies of the paid receipts for the repair or replacement.
- A landlord must return all security deposits and required interest, if any, minus unpaid rent and expenses for damages, within 45 days from the date the tenant vacates the unit.
- In the event of a fire, a landlord must return all security deposit and required interest, if any, minus unpaid rent and expenses for damages, within seven days from the date that the tenant provides notice of termination of the rental agreement. {Mun. Code Ch. 5-12-110(g)}



- Subject to correcting a deficient amount of interest paid to a tenant on a security deposit, if a landlord fails to comply with specified security deposit requirements the tenant shall be awarded damages in an amount equal to two times the security deposit plus interest.

***For more information regarding security deposits, especially in the event of property transfer, please review the [RLTO Ordinance](#).**

SUBLEASES {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-120}

If a tenant moves prior to the end of the rental agreement, the landlord must make a good faith effort to find a new tenant at a fair rent. However, if the landlord is unsuccessful in re-renting the unit, the tenant remains liable for the rent under the rental agreement, as well as the landlord's cost of advertising. The landlord must accept a reasonable subtenant offered by the tenant without charging additional fees.

ATTORNEY'S FEES {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-180}

Except in eviction actions, the prevailing plaintiff in any action arising from the application of this Ordinance shall be entitled to recover all court costs and reasonable attorney's fees.

What happens if there are problems during tenancy, and what are the available remedies?

TENANT REMEDIES {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-110}

Minor Defects

If the landlord fails to maintain the property in compliance with the Code and the tenant or the tenant's family or guests are not responsible for the failure, the tenant may:

1. Request in writing that the landlord make repairs within 14 days, and if the landlord fails to do so the tenant may withhold an amount of rent that reasonably reflects the reduced value of the unit. Rent withholding begins from the 15th day until repairs are made; OR
2. Request in writing that the landlord make repairs within 14 days and if the landlord fails to do so the tenant may have the repairs made and deduct up to \$500 or 1/2 of the month's rent without exceeding one month's rent. Repairs must be done in compliance with the Code and receipts must be provided to the landlord; and also
3. File suit against the landlord for damages and injunctive relief.

Major Defects

If the landlord fails to maintain the property in compliance with the Code, and the failure renders the premises not reasonably fit and habitable, the tenant may request in writing that the landlord make repairs within 14 days. If repairs are not made, the tenant may immediately terminate the lease and the landlord shall return all prepaid rent, security and interest recoverable by the tenant. If the tenant does not move out in 30 days then the tenant's notice is considered withdrawn.

*Failure to Provide Essential Services**

If, contrary to the lease, an essential service is not provided (heat, running or hot water, electricity, gas, or plumbing) and this is NOT due to a utility provider's failure, or if the landlord fails to maintain the building in material compliance with the Code, and the tenant or tenant's family or guests are not responsible for such failure, after giving written notice, the tenant may do ONE of the following:

1. Get the essential service restored and deduct the cost from the rent after giving the landlord paid receipts; OR
2. File a lawsuit against the landlord and recover damages based on the reduced value of the dwelling unit; OR
3. Get substitute housing and be excused from paying rent for the period that the tenant cannot stay in the rental unit, OR
4. Request that the landlord correct the failure within 24 hours and if the landlord fails to do so, withhold from the monthly rent an amount that reasonably reflects the reduced value of its premises.

***For more information, review the [RLTO Ordinance](#).**



Fire or Casualty Damage

If a fire damages the unit to an extent that it is in material noncompliance with the Code and the tenant, tenant's family or guests are not responsible for the fire or accident, the tenant may:

1. Move out immediately and provide written notice to the landlord of the intention to terminate the rental agreement within 14 days after moving out.
2. If legal, the tenant may stay in the unit but if they cannot use a portion of the unit because of damage, the rent may be reduced to reflect the reduced value of the unit.
3. If the tenant stays, and the landlord fails to diligently carry work to repair the rental unit, the tenant may notify the landlord, in writing, within 14 days after the tenant becomes aware that the work is not being diligently carried out, of the tenant's intention to terminate the rental agreement and move out.

LANDLORD REMEDIES*

WHAT HAPPENS IF A TENANT PAYS RENT LATE?

- If the tenant fails to pay rent on time, the landlord may charge a late fee of \$10.00 per month on rents under \$500 plus 5% per month on that part of the rent that exceeds \$500.00 {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-140 (H)}
- If the tenant fails to pay rent, the landlord, after giving five days written notice to the tenant, may terminate the rental agreement. However, the tenant may remain in the unit with a rental agreement in good standing if the tenant pays the full amount of back rent and landlord court filing fees before a judge issues an eviction order.
- If, however, the tenant uses this provision and later receives a second written notice of nonpayment, the tenant will have only five days to pay unpaid rent and will not have an opportunity to pay the back rent to ensure dismissal of the eviction action. {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-130(a)}
 - If the landlord accepts the late rent, the landlord may not evict the tenant. {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-130 (g)}
 - If the tenant fails to comply with the Code or the rental agreement, the landlord may give a written notice to the tenant of the specific acts or omissions that violated the code or rental agreement, and of the tenant's right to remedy the breach within 10 days. The landlord may terminate the rental agreement if tenant fails to correct the violation within the 10-day notice period. {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-130 (b)}
 - If the tenant fails to comply with the Code or the rental agreement, the landlord may request in writing that the tenant comply as promptly as conditions permit in the case of emergency, or within 14 days. If the breach is not corrected in the specified period, the landlord may enter the dwelling unit and have the necessary work done. In this case, the tenant shall be responsible for all costs of repairs. {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-130 (c)}

***For more information, review the [RLTO Ordinance](#).**

PROHIBITION ON RETALIATORY CONDUCT BY LANDLORD {MUN. CODE CH. 5-12-150}

A tenant has the right to complain or testify in good faith about their tenancy to governmental agencies or officials, police, media, community groups, tenant unions or the landlord. A tenant has the right to undertake any right or remedy provided by law without retaliation from the landlord. A landlord is prohibited from retaliating by terminating or threatening to terminate a tenancy, increasing rent, decreasing services, bringing, or threatening to bring an eviction action, or refusing to renew a lease agreement.

For more information

Visit the City of Chicago Department of Housing website at: chicago.gov/rlto. For a copy of the Ordinance, visit the Office of the City Clerk, Room 107, City Hall, 121 North LaSalle Street, Chicago, Illinois or view it at the Municipal Reference Library, Harold Washington Library, 5th Floor, 400 S. State Street, Chicago, Illinois.

A message about porch safety:

The porch or deck of this building should be designed for a live load of up to 100 lbs. per square foot and is safe only for its intended use. Protect your safety. Do not overload the porch or deck. If you have questions about porch or deck safety, call the City of Chicago non-emergency number, 3-1-1.

Preventing **BEDBUG** Infestations in Apartments



**HEALTHY
CHICAGO**
CHICAGO DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC HEALTH

Bed bugs can be found in homes, apartments, hotels, schools, dormitories, shelters, offices and other places. This brochure provides information on bed bugs and what you should do if you have or suspect you have a bed bug infestation in your apartment. It also describes your rights and responsibilities as a tenant.

Why is this brochure being provided to me?

In 2013, the City of Chicago passed an ordinance to help address the growing problem of bed bugs. This ordinance provides that landlords and tenants share the responsibility in preventing and controlling bed bug infestations. Further, the ordinance requires that landlords provide an informational brochure on bed bugs to tenants. This informational brochure, developed by the Chicago Department of Public Health, is intended to meet this requirement.

What are bed bugs?

Bed bugs are small, flat, wingless insects. They feed on blood and can be a nuisance for individuals. They are named for their tendency to live on mattresses or other parts of a bed.



**Adult bed bug-actual size.*

What do bed bugs look like?

Adult bed bugs are roughly the size, shape and color of an apple seed: 1/4 of an inch in length and light or reddish-brown in color. Immature forms of bed bugs are smaller and lighter in color. Eggs are tiny and white. You should be able to see the adult form with your naked eye, but may need a magnifying glass to see the immature forms or eggs. Please refer to the website listed at the end of this brochure for pictures of bed bugs.

Where do bed bugs live?

Bed bugs can be found anywhere people sleep, sit or lay down. They can be found on mattresses and box springs, especially near the piping, seams and tags, and in cracks and crevices of head boards and bed frames. They can also be found in other furniture, especially in the seams and zippers of chairs and couches, in the folds of curtains, in drawer joints, in electrical outlets, behind picture frames and in other tight spaces.



1

How can bed bugs get into an apartment?

Bed bugs can get into an apartment by hitching a ride on mattresses or other bedding, furniture, clothing and baggage. Once in an apartment, they can crawl from one room to another, or get into an adjacent apartment by crawling through small cracks or holes in walls or ceilings or under doors. Because bed bugs do not have wings, they cannot fly into or around your apartment.

What can I do to prevent bed bugs from getting into my apartment?



Bed bugs can be found most anywhere, so ALWAYS be aware of your surroundings. Always check furniture and bedding, especially those bought secondhand, for signs of bed bugs before you buy them. NEVER bring items that someone else has disposed of into your apartment, as these items may be infested with bed bugs. When returning home from travel within or from outside the U.S., ALWAYS inspect your luggage carefully for signs of bed bugs before you bring the luggage into your apartment.

What else can I do to prevent a bed bug infestation?
Reduce clutter, especially in bedrooms. Store unused items in sealed containers or plastic bags. Wash and dry bedding often. Check beds and furniture for signs of bed bugs. Purchase mattress and box spring covers.

Do bed bugs transmit disease?
No, bed bugs are not known to transmit disease.

Are there other health concerns related to bed bugs?
Yes. Their bites, like those of other insects, may cause an allergic reaction with swelling, redness and itching. Their presence may cause people to be anxious and lose sleep.

How do I know if I have a bed bug infestation in my apartment?
Though bites may be an indicator of a bed bug infestation, they are generally a poor one as not all people will react to bed bug bites or the bites may be due to other reasons. The best indication of an infestation is to look for physical signs of bed bugs such as live or dead bed bugs, eggs or eggshells or tiny dark spots or reddish stains on mattresses or other places where bed bugs live.



2

What should I do if I suspect there are bed bugs in my apartment?

Under this ordinance, tenants MUST call their landlord immediately then follow-up in writing. Tenants SHOULD NOT try to get rid of the bed bugs by applying chemicals, “bug bombs” or pesticides as these do not work and could make you, your family or neighbors sick. Once a tenant has notified the landlord, wait for additional instructions from the landlord and pest management professional. Prompt notification and treatment will help prevent the further spread of bed bugs.

Should I dispose of bedding, clothing or other materials that may be infested?

Disposing of these items is probably not necessary unless directed by a pest management professional. If there are items that do need to be disposed of, do so carefully by sealing them in plastic bags so as to not spread bed bugs further. The ordinance prohibits the recycling of any bed bug infested materials and requires that any bed bug infested materials be totally enclosed in a plastic bag and labeled as being infested with bed bugs when disposed.

What should I do with any linens or clothes that may be infested?

- Wash all linen and other infested materials (including clothing) in hot water, then after drying the clothes, keep them in the dryer and dry for an additional 20 minutes on the highest setting.
- Put un-washable or “dry clean only” materials in the dryer on the highest setting for at least 20 minutes.
- If you have to launder in a common area of the building or at a laundromat, make sure all items are enclosed in a bag before leaving your apartment to prevent the further spread of bed bugs.
- Once all these materials are laundered and dried, seal them in clean bags so bed bugs can’t re-infest them.

What are my responsibilities as a tenant under this ordinance?

Tenants have two main responsibilities under this ordinance:
1) Notify your landlord within 5 days of suspecting a bed bug infestation;
2) Cooperate with the landlord by adhering to the following:

- Don’t interfere with an inspection or with a treatment.
- Grant access to your apartment for an inspection or a treatment.
- Make the necessary preparations, as instructed by your landlord or a pest management professional, prior to an inspection or a treatment.
- Dispose of any items that a pest management professional has determined can not be treated or cleaned.
- Enclose in a plastic bag any personal property that will be moved through any common area of the building, or stored in any other location.

Are there any exemptions to these tenant responsibilities?

Yes. The ordinance exempts tenants who live in an assisted living or shared housing establishment, or similar living arrangement, where the establishment is required to provide the tenant assistance with activities of daily living or mandatory services. In such cases, the landlord is responsible for making the necessary preparations and removing or disposing of any personal property.

What penalties can a tenant face for not complying with these requirements?

The ordinance allows the city to issue fines to tenants for not complying with these requirements. Fines can go as high as \$2,000 for a third offense. Landlords can not fine tenants.

What are my rights as a tenant under this ordinance?

Landlords can’t retaliate against a tenant if the tenant:

- Complains of a bed bug infestation to a governmental agency elected representative or public official charged with responsibility for enforcement of a building, housing, health or similar code.
- Complains of a bed bug infestation to a community organization or to the news-media.
- Seeks the assistance of a community organization or the news-media to remedy a bed bug infestation.
- Asks the landlord to provide pest control measures.
- Testifies in court concerning any bed bug infestation.

What are my landlord’s responsibilities under this ordinance?

Landlords have three main responsibilities under this ordinance:
1) Educate tenants about bed bugs by providing this brochure when tenants sign a new or renew an existing lease or other rental agreement;
2) Notify tenants prior to any inspection or treatment of their apartment for bed bugs and provide instructions for preparing the apartment.
3) Get rid of the bed bug infestation by providing pest control services by a pest management professional and paying for this service.

How much time does a landlord have to provide a pest management professional?

The ordinance allows landlords up to 10 days to have a pest management professional come to inspect your apartment.

Does the ordinance require any specific type of inspection or treatment?

If bed bugs are in an apartment, there is a chance they may be found in additional apartments in that same building, especially those closest to the apartment with the bed bugs. As a result, the apartments on either side and directly above and below the apartment with the bed bugs need to be inspected and if necessary, treated. Treatment will only occur if bed bugs are found.

Do these requirements apply to condominiums or cooperative building?

Yes, but only to units that are being rented.

What penalties can a landlord face for not complying with these requirements?

The ordinance allows the city to issue fines to landlords for not complying with these requirements. Fines can go as high as \$2,000 for a third offense.

What should I do if my landlord is not responsive?

If you suspect there are bed bugs in your apartment, call your landlord immediately and follow-up in writing. Give your landlord up to 10 days to have a pest management professional come to inspect your apartment. If your landlord is not responsive, call 311 and file a complaint.



Additional information, including a copy of the ordinance, can be found at:

www.cityofchicago.org/health

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